

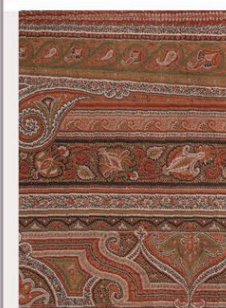


1861

Visiting outfit This bodice and skirt has copious lengths of pleated, black fabric applied by sewing machine. Pagoda sleeves reveal *engageantes* (undersleeves) of cotton, muslin, or lace that were detached for laundering.

Walking outfit *The Englishwoman's Domestic Magazine* was a fount of fashion advice, and gave patterns for bodices and coats like this paletot. Checked fabric was popular, and the outfit clearly borrows elements from menswear.

WOOL AND SILK WEAVES



Cashmere wool shawl, c.1860 (detail)



Machine-woven silk daisies (apron detail)

The range of materials and complex patterning available to women by 1860 was extraordinary. The textile industry in Britain vied with Indian manufacturers to satisfy increasing demand and changing tastes. Edinburgh, Crayford in Essex, Norwich, and later Paisley produced wool shawls. Huge, double-square, long shawls were folded in half and then diagonally draped across the large skirts. Jacquard looms could produce wide lengths of woven silk to look like embroidery that could be used for dress skirts, and accessories such as aprons, as here. The subtlety of colour gradation, and accuracy in depicting specific flowers, are quite remarkable.



1867

Tartan dress This day dress is of three-colour checked wool: red, pale green, and heather blue. A horsehair pad supports the back fullness of the skirt. Velvet rickrack (zigzag) braid trim suggests a collar. Rosettes were a popular feature in 1867–70.



1868

Fringing and ribbon decoration

Royal blue This silk moiré outfit has separate bodice and skirt – the front-fastening bodice made getting dressed much easier. Here a small crinoline frame gives buoyancy and, with the squared bodice and apron front, anticipates 1870s styles.



1869

Madame Vignon creation The bodice sleeves on this magenta-coloured silk outfit are slashed in Italian Renaissance style. The skirt, with mock apron and peplum overskirt, trails along the ground, and paves the way for the onset of bustled-up skirts.